

Ryan Weldzius, Ph.D.

CONTACT INFORMATION

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Villanova University
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science 2020–present

Princeton University
Postdoctoral Fellow, Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance 2019–2020

Washington University in St. Louis
Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Political Science 2018–2019

EDUCATION

PhD, Political Science, University of California, Los Angeles 2018

MSc, Economics, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin 2012

MA, Politics, New York University 2010

BA, Political Science, DePaul University 2007
United States Military Academy, West Point, 2003–2005

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Weldzius, Ryan and Joshua Buckson. 2026. “Beyond the Greenback: Currency Power in a Greener, More Fragmented World.” *PS: Political Science & Politics* (forthcoming).

Peritz, Lauren, Ryan Weldzius, Ronald Rogowski, and Thomas Flaherty. 2022. “[Enduring the Great Recession: Economic Integration in the European Union](#).” *The Review of International Organizations* 17: 175–203.

Weldzius, Ryan. 2021. “[The End of Currency Manipulation? Global Production Networks and Exchange Rate Politics](#).” *Economics and Politics* 33(3): 514–32.

Ifft, Jennifer, Deepak Rajagopal, and Ryan Weldzius. 2019. “[Ethanol Plant Location and Land Use: A Case Study of the Conservation Reserve Program and Ethanol Mandate](#).” *Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy* 41(1): 37–55.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Weldzius, Ryan, James Raymond Vreeland, and James H. Bisbee. 2022. “[Political Cleavages and Exposure to the Global Financial Crisis](#),” in *The Backlash Against Globalization: What’s Next?*, a Report from the Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance: pp. 33–37.

Weldzius, Ryan. 2019. “[Currency Statecraft: Monetary Rivalry and Geopolitical Ambition](#). By Benjamin J. Cohen Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2019. 208p. \$75.00 cloth, \$25.00 paper.” *Perspectives on Politics* 17(3): 945–946.

World Trade Organization. 2014. *Trade and Development: Recent Trends and the Role of the WTO*. [Contributor]

UNDER REVIEW

Green Industrial Transformation and the Reordering of Currency Power.

Monopolies for Sale: The Anti-Competitive Effects of Trade Liberalization (with Nils Gudat).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

BOOK PROJECTS

The Exporters' Paradox: How Global Supply Chains Turned Exporters Against Currency Manipulation (submission in June 2026). The book provides a novel explanation for why governments might end their strategy of currency manipulation and what factors might spark a reversal. I argue that the globalization of production over the last two decades, where firms increasingly rely on imported inputs to produce their final goods, has changed the conventional benefits of an undervalued exchange rate. When firms import more inputs, an undervalued exchange rate does not provide a competitive boost to exports and currency manipulation recedes; however, when a global shock disrupts production networks – e.g., during the COVID-19 lock downs – the benefits of an undervalued exchange rate can return, sparking a new, albeit smaller, bout of currency wars. I test the theoretical implications of my model of exchange rate politics using a mix of cross-country data, firm-level survey data, and carefully selected case studies in Czechia, Japan, South Korea, and Taiwan.

Reshoring Global Supply Chains: A Political Economy of Geoeconomic Risk (solicited submission for the Cambridge University Press Elements series “Globalization and Supply Chains”. Submission in August 2026). Why have only some governments committed substantial public funds to reshoring strategic production? Since 2020, a handful of advanced economies have announced more than \$300 billion in subsidies to repatriate semiconductor, pharmaceutical, and advanced manufacturing production, while many other countries facing comparable dependence on adversarial suppliers have done nothing. This Element argues that direct reshoring requires the alignment of three structural conditions: significant but not prohibitive dependence on the supplier country, low bilateral trust toward that supplier, and sufficient domestic capacity to scale production. The framework is tested through cross-national analysis of reshoring commitments since 2007 and matched case studies of Japan and New Zealand, South Korea and Czechia, and the United States and Australia, drawing on fieldwork conducted in Czechia, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, and the United States between 2024 and 2026.

ARTICLE-LENGTH PROJECTS

- Political Cleavages and Exposure to the Global Financial Crisis (with James H. Bisbee and James Raymond Vreeland).
- Economic Interdependence and Regional Monetary Convergence (with James H. Bisbee).

GRANTS

- [1] Villanova University, Institute for Teaching and Learning, Summer Course Improvement Grant, \$3,560, 2025; designed a [fully online data science course platform](#)
- [2] Villanova University, Grants for Research for Arts and Sciences Professors (GRASP), \$18,350, 2024-2026; Preparatory work for NSF CAREER application, Summer 2024; Research in Japan and South Korea, Spring 2026.
- [3] Villanova University, Faculty Research and Development Grant, for book workshop in April 2025, \$3,500, 2023
- [4] Villanova University, Conference Travel Grant, \$2,400, 2024; Research/invited presentation in Taiwan, May/June 2024

	[5] APSA Summer Centennial Center Research Grant, \$1,800, 2023 [6] Villanova University, Summer Research Grant, \$12,000, 2023 [7] Villanova University, Institute for Teaching and Learning, Summer Course Improvement Grant, \$5,500, 2022; designed a ShinyApp data viz portal for students [8] Villanova University, Conference Travel Grant, \$3,450, 2022; Summer conference travel to Munich, Germany and Prague, Czech Republic [9] NSF, Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Summer Institute, UC Berkeley, \$1,500, 2017 [10] Center for European and Russian Studies Conference Travel Grant, UCLA, \$300, 2017 [11] Conference Travel Grants, UCLA, \$300/year, 2015–2017 [12] Graduate Summer Research Mentorship, UCLA, \$6,000, 2015 [13] Graduate Summer Research Mentorship, UCLA, \$6,000, 2013 [14] Center for European and Eurasian Studies Summer Language Study Grant (German), UCLA, \$1,750, 2013
FELLOWSHIPS & CERTIFICATES	[1] University Graduate Fellowship, UCLA, 2012-2018 [2] Master's Certificate in Public Policy Analysis, Alexander Hamilton Center for Political Economy, NYU, 2010
INVITED TALKS	[1] Hertie School of Governance, April 23, 2026. Talk title: “The Exporters’ Paradox: How Global Supply Chains Turned Exporters Against Currency Manipulation.” [2] University of Minnesota, International Relations Colloquium, February 9, 2026. Talk title: “Green Industrial Transformation and the Reordering of Currency Power.” [3] University of Kansas, Trade War Lab, November 19, 2025. Talk Title: “Currency Power in Transition: Commodity Trade and the Politics of Global Currency Hierarchies.” [4] Academia Sinica, Taipei, Taiwan, June 4, 2024. Talk title: “Monopolies for Sale: The Anti-Competitive Effects of Trade Liberalization.” [5] National Taiwan University, May 28, 2024. Talk title: “Currency Wars in Retreat: Global Value Chains and Exchange Rate Politics.” [6] Princeton University, Europe Center, April 17, 2024. Talk title: “The Chains That Bind: How Global Value Chain Integration in the EMU Buffers Global Shocks.” [7] University of Washington, Political Economy Speaker Series, March 2020 (cancelled). Talk title: “Central bank interdependence.” [8] Princeton University, Europe Center, April 2020 (cancelled). Talk title: “European integration in times of crisis.” [9] Princeton University, International Relations Colloquium, September 2019. Talk title: “The End of Currency Manipulation? Global Production Networks and Exchange Rate Outcomes.”
CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS	SUMMARY - International Political Economy Society: 2016, 2017, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2025 - Conference of the DVPW Section Political Economy, Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz (Germany): 2025 - Global Value Chains in a Geopolitically Fragmented World: Trade, Security, and Resilience, Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance, Princeton University: 2025 - American Political Science Association: 2016, 2017, 2019, 2021, 2023, 2024

- Temple University Workshop on International Institutions and Global Governance (TWIIGG): 2023
- Drei-Länder International Political Economy Society (Germany): 2022
- European Political Science Association: 2022
- International Studies Association: 2022
- Firms, States, and Global Production, National University of Singapore: 2019
- Midwest Political Science Association: 2015, 2016
- Council for European Studies: 2016
- Policy Making Under Hard Times: Southern European Countries in a Comparative Perspective, UC3JM, Madrid, Spain: 2014
- Alexander Hamilton Center Graduate Student Conference, NYU: 2010, 2011
- Berlin Colloquium for Economic History, Humboldt-Universität: 2011

PRESENTATION DETAILS

- [1] “Currency Power in Transition: Commodity Trade and the Politics of Global Currency Hierarchies,” paper presented at the **International Political Economy Society**, University of California, Los Angeles, October 2025.
- [2] “Political Cleavages and Exposure to Global Shocks,” paper presented at the **Conference of the DVPW Section Political Economy, Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz**, Mainz, Germany, September 2025.
- [3] “The Greenback in a Green World: The Green Transition and Currency Internationalization,” paper presented at the **American Political Science Association**, Philadelphia, September 2024.
- [4] “Monopolies for Sale: The Anti-Competitive Effects of Preferential Trade Agreements,” paper presented at the **Temple University Workshop on International Institutions and Global Governance (TWIIGG)** in Philadelphia, October 13, 2023.
- [5] “Economic Interdependence and Regional Monetary Convergence,” paper presented at the **International Political Economy Society**, University of Pittsburgh, October 2022.
- [6] “Economic Interdependence and Regional Monetary Convergence,” paper presented at the **Drei-Länder International Political Economy Society**, Technische Universität München (Germany), June 2022.
- [7] “Economic Interdependence and Regional Monetary Convergence,” paper presented by panel chair Dennis Quinn (due to COVID-19 scare) at the **European Political Science Association**, Prague (Czech Republic), June 2022.
- [8] “Economic Interdependence and Regional Monetary Convergence,” paper presented at the **International Studies Association**, Nashville, April 2022.
- [9] “Reshoring Global Supply Chains Post,” (with Abigail Vaughn) paper presented at the **American Political Science Association**, Seattle (Virtual), September 2021.
- [10] “Political Cleavages and Exposure to the Global Financial Crisis,” (with James Raymond Vreeland and James H. Bisbee) paper presented at the **International Political Economy Society**, Ohio State University (Virtual), October 2020.
- [11] “The End of Currency Manipulation? Global Production Networks and Exchange Rate Outcomes,” paper presented at the **International Political Economy Society**, University California, San Diego, October 2019.
- [12] “The End of Currency Manipulation? Global Production Networks and Exchange Rate Outcomes,” paper presented at the **American Political Science Association**, Washington, D.C., September 2019.

- [13] “Central Banks in Chains? Interdependence and Monetary Outcomes,” paper presented at the Workshop for special issue of *Economics & Politics* “**Firms, States, and Global Production**,” at the National University of Singapore, March 2019.
- [14] “Globalizing the Value Chain: Firm-Level Preferences for Exchange Rate Policy,” paper presented at the **International Political Economy Society**, University of Texas, Austin, October 2017.
- [15] “Globalizing the Value Chain: Firm-Level Preferences for Exchange Rate Policy,” paper presented at the **American Political Science Association**, San Francisco, September 2017.
- [16] “European Integration in Crisis: Specialization and the Differential Impact of the Great Recession,” (with Lauren Peritz, Ronald Rogowski, and Thomas Flaherty) paper presented at the **International Political Economy Society**, Duke University, October 2016.
- [17] “The End of the Secret Tariff? Value Chain Integration and Exchange Rate Politics,” paper presented at the **American Political Science Association**, Philadelphia, September 2016.
- [18] “European Integration in Crisis: Specialization and the Differential Impact of the Great Recession,” (with Lauren Peritz, Ronald Rogowski, and Thomas Flaherty) paper presented at the **Council for European Studies**, Philadelphia, April 2016.
- [19] “The Political Economy of Market Size, Trade, and Productivity,” (with Nils Gudat) paper presented at the **Midwest Political Science Association**, Chicago, April 2016.
- [20] “Predicting Individual Trade-Policy Preferences: A Factor Content Approach,” paper presented at the **Midwest Political Science Association**, Chicago, April 2015.
- [21] “European Integration and Asymmetric Shocks,” (with Lauren Peritz, Ronald Rogowski, and Thomas Flaherty) paper presented at the Workshop *Policy Making Under Hard Times: Southern European Countries in a Comparative Perspective*, UC3JM, Madrid, Spain, November 2014.
- [22] “The Competitive Effects of Trade Liberalization in North America,” (with Nils Gudat, presenter) paper presented at the **Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics**, Milan, Italy, 2013.
- [23] “Land Reform and Divergence in Economic Growth: Evidence from India,” paper presented at the **Berlin Colloquium for Economic History**, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany, June 2011.
- [24] “Land Reform and Divergence in Economic Growth: Evidence from India,” paper presented at the **Alexander Hamilton Center Graduate Student Conference** at New York University, May 2011.
- [25] “Property Rights, Inequality, and Economic Growth: Why South Korea Burgeoned and the Philippines Stagnated,” paper presented at the **Alexander Hamilton Center Graduate Student Conference** at New York University, May 2010.

CONFERENCE
PARTICIPATION

- Kiel-Göttingen-CEPR Conference on China in the Global Economy** June ‘25
 - Discussant for “How China Collateralizes,” by Gelpern, Haddad, Horn, Kintzinger, Parks, and Trebesch.
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting** August 2023
 - Co-Discussant with Timm Betz, “Global Value Chains (GVCs) and Global Economic Orders,” *International Political Economy*
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting** Sept 2022
 - Discussant, “Trade, Automation, and Attitudes,” *International Political Economy*
- European Political Science Association Annual Meeting** June 2022

- Chair/Discuss., “Theoretical Implications of Empirical Models,” Formal Models
- International Studies Association Annual Meeting** Apr 2022
- Chair/Discuss., “Taxation,” International Political Economy
- Discussant, “Central Banks, Debt & Monetary Policy,” International Political Economy
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting** Sept 2021
- Discussant, “Exchange Rates & Government Credibility,” International Political Economy
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting** April 2021
- Chair/Discuss., “Inequality, Money, and Power,” Comparative Political Economy

- GUEST LECTURES
- [1] University of Florida, undergraduate course “Applied Political Behavior,” virtual lecture and discussion on the paper “Political Cleavages and Exposure to the Global Financial Crisis,” October 2022.
 - [2] Denver University, undergraduate course “International Political Economy,” virtual lecture and discussion on the topic “Global supply chains and global politics,” January 2022.
 - [3] University of Florida, undergraduate course “European Politics,” virtual lecture and discussion on the topic “Austerity and Populism in Europe,” November 2021.
 - [4] Denver University, undergraduate course “International Political Economy,” virtual lecture and discussion on the topic “Pandemics, Global Supply Chains, and Debt,” May 2021.
 - [5] University of California, Los Angeles, undergraduate course “International Political Economy,” virtual lecture and discussion on the topic “International Institutions and Trade,” April 2021.
 - [6] University of Florida, undergraduate course “Applied Political Behavior,” virtual lecture and discussion on the paper “Predicting Revealed Trade Preferences: A Factor Content Approach,” March 2021.
 - [7] University of Alabama, undergraduate course “Global Governance,” virtual lecture and discussion on the paper “Cooperation, Conflict, and Crisis in the Contemporary Global Economic System,” October 2020.
 - [8] Columbia University, graduate course “International Political Economy,” virtual lecture and discussion on the topic “Currency Manipulation and International Trade,” August 2020.

- WORKSHOPS ORGANIZED
- [1] Comparative Politics Graduate Student Conference (COMPASS), co-organizer, UCLA, 2016

TEACHING	Villanova University	
	PSC 2240 - International Political Economy	F20, F21
	PSC 2380 - European Politics	S21, F21, S22
	PSC 4175 - Intro to Data Science	F24, Summer25, F25
	PSC 4275 - The Politics of Financial Crises	S21, S22, S23
	PSC 4375 - Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences	S25
	PSC 6503 - Internship Advisor	AY21/22, AY22/23, AY24/25, AY25/26
	PSC 6900 - Money, Power, and Politics (senior seminar)	S23
	PSC 7000 - Research Concepts & Approaches (graduate)	F24, F25
	PSC 8270 - International Political Economy (graduate)	S21, Summer22

PSC 8275 - The Politics of Financial Crises (graduate)	S23
PSC 8375 - Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences (graduate)	S25
PSC 8380 - European Politics (graduate)	F20

Washington University in St. Louis

POLSCI 3171 - Political Economy of European Populism	S19
POLSCI 565 - Political Economy of Financial Crises (graduate)	S19

University of California, Los Angeles

Instructor

IASTD 160 - The 'United States' of Europe: Understanding the Political Economy of European Integration (International Area Studies; used in application for EU Excellence grant), Summer 2014

Teaching Assistant

POLSCI 120 - US Foreign Relations, Deborah Larson	F14, W15, F15, F16, F17
POLSCI 124 - Internat. Political Economy, Ron Rogowski	W14, S15, W16, S17, S18
POLSCI 125 - The Nuclear Age in World Politics, Joslyn Barnhart	W18
POLSCI 134 - U.S. Foreign Policy Decision Making, Arthur Stein	W17
POLSCI 168 - Comparative Political Analysis, Ron Rogowski	S14, S16
POLSCI 231 - International Political Economy (graduate), Ron Rogowski	S16

Universidad de La Habana

Development Economics (co-instructor, graduate), Havana, Cuba Summer 2011

UNIVERSITY AND DEPARTMENT SERVICE

Faculty Congress Representative , Villanova University	2024-present
- Academic Policy Committee, Student Evaluations Subcommittee	
Artificial Intelligence Committee , Villanova University	2025-2026
- Faculty committee member, discuss/propose/approve departmental issues related to AI in teaching and research	
DEI Committee , Villanova University	2024-2025
- Faculty committee member, discuss/propose/approve departmental issues related to DEI	
Undergraduate Studies Committee , Villanova University	2020-2024
- Faculty committee member, discuss/propose/approve departmental issues related to undergraduate studies	
Undergraduate Honors Thesis , Villanova University	2022-2023
- Faculty co-chair/advisor, advised a student's year-long research project for the Honors program at Villanova, Title: "War, What is it Good for? The Effect of Military Conflicts on Trust in the EU."	
Fulbright Campus Committee , Villanova University	2022
- Faculty committee member, assisted the Villanova Center for Research and Fellowships with Fulbright application assessments	
Political Risk Apprenticeship Program , Villanova University	S21, S22
- Faculty co-chair/advisor, advised 10-12 students in the Spring semester 2021 and 2022 (for internship credits) on how to conduct political risk analyses. Students worked with Villanova graduates in the field of risk analysis, producing reports on a topic related to the clients' needs.	
American Politics Search Committee , Villanova University	2021
- Faculty committee member, search for new tenure-track faculty hire (successful)	
Summer Undergraduate Research Program , Villanova University	2021

	- Faculty co-chair/advisor, directed two undergraduate students to help with a summer research project for my book manuscript. Included training the students on how to conduct the research and guest lecturing in the larger summer research program (10 students) on how I conduct research for my projects.
	Undergraduate Honors Thesis , Villanova University 2020-2021 - Faculty chair/advisor, advised a student's year-long research project for the Honors program at Villanova, Title: "Disappearing Borders: Internaitonal Protections for Climate Refugees within the United Nations."
	Undergraduate Honors Thesis , Villanova University 2020-2021 - Faculty chair/advisor, advised a student's year-long research project for the Honors program at Villanova, Title: "The (Exogenous) Responsibility Hypothesis: Economic Voting in a Post-Brexit Ireland."
	Political Science Student Advisory Council , Villanova University 2020-2021 - Faculty committee member, student group to discuss issues among political science majors regarding COVID-19 online/hybrid teaching and race relations on campus following the murder of George Floyd
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	Reviewer for <i>American Political Science Review</i> , <i>American Journal of Political Science</i> , <i>British Journal of Politial Science</i> , <i>Comparative Political Studies</i> , <i>Digest of Middle East Studies</i> , <i>International Organization</i> , <i>Journal of Politics</i> , <i>Perspectives on Politics</i>
PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP	American Political Science Association European Political Science Association International Political Economy Society International Studies Association
RESEARCH POSITIONS	Research Assistant to Professor Deepak Rajagopal, UCLA 2015 Intern , Economic Research and Statistics Division, World Trade Organization 2013 Research Assistant to Professor Ronald Rogowski, UCLA 2013 Research Assistant to Professor Dr. Nikolaus Wolf, HU-Berlin 2011-2012 Research Assistant to Professor Dr. Bergnt-Arne Wickström, HU-Berlin 2011
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Consultant , <i>5M RE, Inc.</i> , Chicago, IL 2016-2017 Social Coordinator , <i>HU-Berlin, International Office</i> , Berlin, Germany 2011-2012 Portfolio Manager , <i>Millennium Properties R/E, Inc.</i> , Chicago, IL 2006-2009
SPECIALIZED TRAINING	Computing: R, STATA, Python, ArcGIS, QGIS, $\LaTeX$. Languages: English (native), German (intermediate, B2), Italian (beginner).